

PRECAUTIONARY MEASURES

- Before building, check the area for signs or a history of flooding and find out how many feet above ground level you need to build your house, if building in a flood prone area, purchase flood insurance.
- Locate houses and buildings away from flood prone areas such as river banks and flood plains.
- Do not throw away garbage or large unwanted appliances or other forms of white waste into rivers, ravines or drains. Utilise proper available waste disposal methods.
- Maintain all drainage systems. Clear river channels of debris and overgrown vegetation. This will facilitate an easier flow of water in the river channel. Keep gutters and down-pipes clear of debris and garbage as well.
- Construct flood barriers where necessary to prevent flood water from entering buildings and homes.

BEFORE A FLOOD

- Develop a Family Emergency Plan.
- Make sure all family members know what immediate action to take to ensure their personal safety. Preparing a family evacuation plan can assist in this regard.
- Secure all important documents, such as birth certificates, passports and the like in waterproof bags or sealed containers.
- Secure valuables and park vehicles in places that will not become flooded.
- Secure your pets on higher ground. If unable to take pets with you, let pets loose so that they will be able to seek higher ground on their own.
- Always monitor weather conditions.
- Build an emergency kit, as well as a grab and go bag for the car, home and workplace, wherever you are.

DURING A FLOOD

- Stay calm. Listen to the radio or television for updated information.
- Move to upper levels of buildings or houses if the lower levels are threatened by flood waters.
- Turn off utilities, such as electricity, gas, water, at the main switches. Do not touch electrical equipment if you are standing in water or are wet.
- Do not drive through flood waters. If flood waters rise around your car, abandon the car and move to higher ground once it is safe to do so.
- Do not seek shelter under culverts or bridges.
- Advise children never to play in flood waters.
- Store chemicals, important documents and electrical devices on elevated surfaces away from expected water levels.
- Move furniture, electrical appliances and other belongings on higher ground where possible.
- Do not go sightseeing in flooded areas.

AFTER A FLOOD

- Do not walk through flood waters unless it is absolutely necessary. Be careful of hidden objects and broken glass when walking in water. If you have to walk in flood water, walk where the water is not moving and use a stick to check the firmness of the ground in front of you. Stay calm. Listen to the radio or television for updated information.
- Exercise extreme caution when entering buildings, as there may be hidden damage, particularly in foundations.
- Gas and fuel pipes may have been damaged. Use flash lights instead of open flames to investigate buildings.
- Report broken utility lines to the public utility company (T&TEC, WASA, TSTT).
- Do not touch live electrical equipment in wet areas.
- If injured, seek medical assistance at the nearest hospital. Health centre or first aid station.
- Do not consume food that has come into contact with flood waters.
- Boil drinking water for at least 10-15 minutes before drinking or treat with sterilisation tablets where available.
- Bury all dead animals as soon as possible.
- Appliances that may have been flooded pose a risk of shock or fire when turned on. Do not use any appliances, heating, pressure, or sewage system until electrical components have been thoroughly cleaned, dried, and inspected by a qualified electrician.



FLOOD PRONE AREAS IN TRINIDAD

Some areas affected by flooding in Trinidad (Water Resources Agency)

CENTRAL

Kelly Village, Caroni, Warren, Nejucal, Caparo, Palmiste, Longdenville, Lange park, Montrose, Arena, Ravine Sable, St Helena, La Paille Village.

SOUTH

Penal, Barrackpore, Woodland, Papourie, Guaracara, Tarouba, Marabella, Gulf City, Cipero, Gasparillo, Guapo, Cap-de-ville, Siparia, Erin, Palo Seco, Claxton Bay, California, Usine Ste. Madeleine, Princess Town, Mayaro, Mafeking Village, San Fernando, South Oropouche, Victoria Village, Ortoire Navet.

NORTH

Moka, Maraval, St. Anns, Cascade, Belmont, Port of Spain, Diego Martin, Cocorite, North Coast Road, Barataria.

EAST

Sangre Grande, Cuanapo, El Reposo, Fishing Pond, Plum Mitán, Santa Cruz, Saddle Road, Cantaro, Pipiol, Mount Lambert, Lopinot, Arima, Arouca, Oropuna, St Helena Village, Piparo.



A DIVISION OF THE MINISTRY OF NATIONAL SECURITY

**In an emergency,
being prepared is key,
so let's Plan and Prepare
in order to safeguard our families,
our community and country.**

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**Everything you need
to know about
FLOODING**

